Signal for attention

Securing readiness before teaching

Use the agreed BSCS signal before instructions, explanations and transitions. Secure readiness before speaking so the beginning of the message reaches the whole class.

How to do it well

1 Prime the transition. State when students will stop and what readiness will look like, before the attention signal.

2 Position visibly. Stand where all students can see you and you can observe the whole room.

3 Use the agreed BSCS signal. Give the current Focus Ready cue consistently and allow students to respond.

4 Pause and scan. Wait for the class to be ready; use a brief, precise correction for the remaining issue.

5 Give the message and check listening. Deliver a concise instruction or explanation, then ask students to retrieve the key action or point.

What this sounds like

“In ten seconds, stop and get Focus Ready.” [Use the agreed BSCS signal.] “Thank you. First, write the title. What is the first action?”

Classroom example. During partner discussion, the teacher primes the stop, moves where all pupils are visible and uses the agreed signal. The teacher waits and corrects two unfinished conversations before giving the instruction. A listening check establishes that students know the first next action. The transition does not begin with several pupils missing the message.

Top tips that make the technique work

Prime the transition. Tell students when they will stop and what readiness will look like before using the signal.

Choose a visible position. Stand where you can see every area and students can see you.

Be seen looking. Scan deliberately; your attention should communicate that you are checking the response.

Wait before academic talk. The signal loses meaning if the explanation starts while conversations or movement continue.

Follow with a listening check. Readiness gives students access to the message; recalling a key instruction shows whether it was received.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Use the current shared BSCS cue consistently.	Speaking over partial attention.
Correct the smallest remaining issue calmly.	Treating eyes towards you as proof that the explanation was understood.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

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